



UNIVERSITY OF
CAMBRIDGE

Department of Engineering

Department of Engineering
University of Cambridge
Trumpington Street
Cambridge, CB2 1PZ
United Kingdom

17 Sep 2025

The School of Artificial Intelligence
The Chinese University of Hong Kong, Shenzhen
Shenzhen, China

Dear Members of the Search Committee,

I am writing to express my strong interest in the **Assistant Professor** position in **Human-Computer Interaction and Mixed Reality** at the School of Artificial Intelligence, The Chinese University of Hong Kong, Shenzhen. I am currently a fourth-year PhD candidate in Intelligent Interactive Systems at the University of Cambridge, supervised by Professor Per Ola Kristensson. My research focuses on reimagining the human body in extended reality (XR) as an intelligent interface that augments selection, interaction, play, and perception. This agenda aligns closely with the newly established School's vision of the advancement of artificial intelligence, and I am excited by the opportunity to contribute to CUHK-Shenzhen's globally leading research and teaching environment.

My research combines **human-computer interaction, embodied interaction design, and AI-driven context-awareness**. I have published over twenty papers at leading venues including ACM TOCHI, CHI, SUI, ISS, CHI PLAY, IEEE VR, ISMAR, and IEEE TVCG. My recent first-author publications in IEEE TVCG advance embodied microgestural interaction in XR for text editing tasks, recognised by the **2025 UKRI Innovate UK Immersive Tech Award for Technical Innovation**. My work on novel selection techniques for disambiguation in XR (ACM SUI 2025) also gained international visibility through my selection as **Cambridge University's delegate** to the **Stockholm International Youth Science Seminar (SIYSS) during Nobel Week 2025**. These achievements highlight my ability to deliver research that is both methodologically rigorous and societally impactful.

My vision for future research builds on my doctoral work to address behaviour modelling, experience design, and fairness in intelligent immersive systems. Specifically, I plan to investigate how human-AI interaction can support situated XR experiences in everyday life and how AI agents can enable new forms of social interaction in immersive environments. This direction not only speaks to fundamental questions of behaviour in design engineering but also connects to application domains including education, healthcare, and cultural heritage. To achieve this, I am developing international collaborations across **Sony Research** (with Professor Jun Rekimoto), **Monash University** (with Professor Florian "Floyd" Mueller), and the **University of Tokyo** (with Professor Masahiko Inami), **UCL** (with Dr. Mark Colley) etc., and within **Cambridge**, including the **Centre for Human-Inspired AI**, **Leverhulme Centre for the Future of Intelligence**, **Engineering Design Centre**, and **Machine Intelligence Lab**, which provide a strong interdisciplinary foundation.



UNIVERSITY OF
CAMBRIDGE

Department of Engineering

I am equally passionate about teaching and student supervision. At Cambridge, I have supervised **undergraduate** and **MPhil** students in **Interaction Design, Further Human-Computer Interaction, and Part II Projects (final-year dissertations)**. I have also supervised students internally and externally from institutions including the University of Liverpool, Hong Kong University of Science and Technology, Xi'an Jiaotong University, Tsinghua University, and Lancaster University. Many of these students have gone on to pursue successful careers in both industry and academia, including PhD studies at top institutions such as Virginia Tech, Cambridge, and Tsinghua. These supervisions have also led to high-quality research outputs published in venues such as IEEE TVCG and IJHCI, where I served as last and corresponding author. I design my teaching to empower students to integrate technical methods with design thinking, preparing them to address complex societal challenges. At CUHK-Shenzhen, I would contribute to teaching in XR, HCI/UX, Human-AI Interaction, and Design Engineering, while also helping develop new material to support the School's evolving curriculum.

Beyond research and teaching, I contribute actively to the academic community, serving as ACM CHI 2026 Technical Program Committee assistant, Technical Program Committee member for IEEE ISEMV and ACM IMX, and as an organiser and social media chair for multiple CHI, CHI PLAY, and DIS conferences. I have also reviewed over 180 papers, receiving multiple recognitions for outstanding reviews. These experiences reflect my commitment to service, collaboration, and leadership in our field.

I believe that my research trajectory, teaching experience, and international collaborations position me well to contribute to this School. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my work on embodied and intelligent systems can advance the School's research themes in Human-Computer Interaction, particularly in the context of the evolving AI era.

Thank you very much for considering my application. I look forward to the opportunity to contribute to The Chinese University of Hong Kong, Shenzhen.

Yours sincerely,

Xiang Li

Homepage: <https://xiang-li.phd/>

PhD Candidate at the Department of Engineering | Information Engineering

Student Fellow at the Leverhulme Centre for the Future of Intelligence

Robinson College | University of Cambridge

+44 (0) 77303-43766